SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE

A Thesis Proposal Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SECONDARY EDUCATION MAJOR IN ENGLISH

By

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
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CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE"** presented and submitted by JOECYL T. MONTALBAN, RUCMINIE U. GESTA, MARIA FE L. BERMAS, RALPH C. BERTUMEN in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of BSED ENGLISH is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

TITLE:	**"EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE**
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I. OBJECTIVES

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DEDICATION

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Curriculum reform is an important strategy for improving education systems around the world. Many countries are adjusting their educational standards to respond to 21st-century skills such as literacy, critical thinking, and global competence. Despite these efforts, curriculum reform in the Philippines continues to face challenges, including too much content, limited teacher preparation, and weak alignment between curriculum goals and assessment practices.

The K to 12 curriculum was introduced to expand basic education and better prepare learners for higher education and employment. However, several problems have appeared during its implementation. These include learning poverty, overloaded lessons, and limited access to teacher training. In response to these concerns, the Department of Education (DepEd) has introduced the MATATAG Curriculum through DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. This curriculum focuses on strong foundational learning, lifelong skills, and simpler content to improve communication skills, critical thinking, and cultural relevance in English education.

Despite these reforms, reports show a clear gap between curriculum goals and students' learning readiness. Many Grade 7 learners still struggle with basic reading and writing skills. This situation creates ongoing difficulties for English teachers and highlights the gap between curriculum policy and classroom practice.

Similar challenges are seen in other countries. Competency-based and flexible curriculum models show both strengths and weaknesses. For example, Indonesia's Merdeka curriculum promotes student-centered learning and the use of English in real-life contexts. However, it also shows the need for continuous teacher training and manageable workloads. Other countries, such

as Kazakhstan, Ghana, Zimbabwe, and Pakistan, report similar problems, including teacher stress, unclear roles, and limited support during curriculum changes.

Researchers describe these issues as a “maturity gap,” where curriculum reforms move faster than teachers and education systems can adjust. As a result, classroom implementation is often incomplete. Although reforms aim to improve education, they often do not fully consider real classroom conditions. In English education, global curriculum goals need to match local learner needs.

In the Philippines, the K to 12 reform aims to modernize education and align it with international standards. However, unclear curriculum directions, mismatched assessments, and limited teacher preparation have slowed its success. Teachers report heavy workloads, few teaching materials, and weak training support. These problems became more serious during the COVID-19 pandemic, which disrupted learning and increased inequality among students.

The MATATAG Curriculum aims to address these long-standing issues by reducing content overload, strengthening basic skills, and increasing cultural relevance. Early feedback shows mixed levels of teacher readiness. Some teachers feel more confident after training, while others still struggle to understand competencies, manage their workload, and meet the needs of diverse learners. Studies emphasize that successful curriculum implementation requires strong school leadership, enough resources, and continuous support.

This study examines how the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide is implemented in Philippine secondary schools, focusing on Grade 7 English classes. Although the curriculum promotes clear goals, reduced content, and skills-based learning, gaps between policy and classroom practice remain. Grade 7 learners moving from elementary to secondary school continue to face reading and language difficulties. Teachers are expected to address these gaps

despite limited training, heavy workloads, and few resources. This situation shows the need to understand teachers' experiences, as they are the main implementers of curriculum reform.

The objectives of this study are to identify the challenges faced by Grade 7 English teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide; to describe how Grade 7 English teachers implement the curriculum; to identify effective practices in meeting learners' diverse needs; and to develop a transition program that supports effective classroom implementation. This study aims to provide context-based findings that support teacher development, improve school support systems, and inform future curriculum decisions.

The significance of this study extends to different groups within the Philippine education system. For teachers, the findings provide practical guidance for lesson planning, classroom instruction, and assessment. For school administrators, the results help in planning training programs, providing resources, and supporting teachers. For the Department of Education, the findings offer evidence to strengthen curriculum implementation and teacher training. Although the study is limited to selected schools, it helps explain how curriculum policy is carried out in real classrooms. In the end, students are the main beneficiaries, as improved English instruction helps develop literacy, critical thinking, and communication skills needed for academic success and lifelong learning.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

The Philippine education system undergoes major changes, and the transition from the K–12 program to the MATATAG Curriculum marks an important shift toward a simpler, more student-centered approach. Based on DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. The MATATAG curriculum aims to reduce the number of learning competencies, strengthen basic literacy and numeracy, and connect teaching practices with Filipino values and global standards.

The curriculum began its implementation in the 2024–2025 school year, starting with Grades 1, 4, and 7 to ensure a smooth, planned rollout. This review looks closely at the early stages of MATATAG, focusing on Grade 7 English teachers, who play a key role in turning policy into actual classroom practice. By examining their teaching challenges, classroom strategies, and ways of adjusting to change, the study aims to show how teachers manage the gap between what the curriculum expects and what happens in real classrooms. In the end, it highlights the important role teachers play in shaping the success of education reform during its early stage.

Curriculum reforms in the Philippine education system

The history of curriculum reform in the Philippines shows a pattern of ambitious ideas, uneven implementation, and frequent changes. Each reform from the K–12 program to the current MATATAG Curriculum reflects the country's continuing efforts to improve education and address long-standing issues in teacher training, school leadership, and student performance. The K to 12 reform, seen as a major shift, was weakened by structural problems and poor execution (Malbas et al., 2023). According to Barrot (2023), the goal of preparing "future-ready" learners was hindered by excessive content and insufficient teacher training. These problems led to the need for a corrective reform.

The MATATAG Curriculum was introduced through DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. It aims to simplify learning goals, eliminate redundant content, and align learning outcomes with the key skills needed for lifelong learning. Estrellado (2023) pointed to decongestion as a major improvement in MATATAG, highlighting its goal to reduce content overload, focus teaching on essential skills, and give teachers more time to help students improve in reading and communication.

Diquito (2024) noted early improvements in subject clarity, especially in science, where clearer learning goals helped teachers focus better and align lessons with classroom tests.

Similarly, Kilag et al., (2024) stated that MATATAG's focus on student-centered, context-based content is a major improvement over the K–12 model, making lessons more relevant and adaptable to classroom needs. However, curriculum reforms in the Philippines are often influenced by political changes rather than regular, evidence-based reviews. The long-term success of MATATAG will likely depend on having systems for ongoing evaluation, strong teacher training, and stable policies across leadership changes.

Current research on curriculum reform in the Philippines is broad but varies in depth and quality. For example, Aguas (2020) said that the success of reform depends mostly on how teachers and school leaders understand and apply policy goals in their schools. Likewise, Nengasca (2025) stressed that successful implementation requires clear guidance, ongoing support, and alignment between policy goals and classroom practice. Together, these studies show that while teachers try to support reform, gaps in training and coordination across schools make consistent implementation difficult.

At the system level, studies by Barrot (2019) and Galaura and Simpal (2025) offer useful insights, but their findings are mostly descriptive. (Barrot, 2019) found ongoing gaps in how subjects are sequenced, how assessments align with teaching, and how lessons connect. Galaura and Simpal (2025) linked poor teaching quality to limited resources and heavy teacher workloads. However, both studies used cross-sectional data, which limits their ability to measure long-term effects on student learning.

This research trend highlights the need for continuous, evidence-based monitoring to evaluate reforms like MATATAG against actual student progress. However, national and regional tests such as PISA (2018) and SEA-PLM show that the Philippines still performs poorly in reading and math. It points to a gap between the goals of reform and real learning results. Even after programs like K–12 and MATATAG, students' reading and writing scores remain among the lowest

globally, especially in Grade 7 English. These findings show the lack of long-term, evidence-based systems that connect curriculum changes to real improvements in literacy. As a result, policymakers often rely on broad national data instead of classroom-level outcomes.

Across Southeast Asia, the MATATAG Curriculum aligns with regional trends toward competency-based, flexible learning. Indonesia's Merdeka Curriculum supports teacher independence, context-based teaching, and ongoing professional development to improve literacy and communication (Indraprasta and Pawiro, 2023). Vietnam used a step-by-step reform process, supported by continuous teacher development, to prepare schools for full implementation. Singapore uses regular curriculum reviews that include assessment data to keep policy and classroom practice aligned. These examples show that successful curriculum reform depends on stable government, steady funding, and organized systems for monitoring.

In conclusion, the MATATAG Curriculum is a response to the problems of the K to 12 program. It focuses on reducing content, making learning more relevant, and giving teachers more control. However, ongoing issues in teacher training, classroom monitoring, and policy stability still put its success at risk. The lack of long-term data and a clear evaluation system makes it hard to know whether MATATAG is improving literacy, especially in English. To achieve real results, reform must be grounded in evidence, supported by robust teacher development, and backed by consistent policies. In the end, Grade 7 English teachers—who act as the main link between policy and classroom practice—will play a key role in showing whether MATATAG teaching goals lead to real progress in student learning and communication skills.

Curriculum Guide

The Curriculum Guide is a document that puts the DepEd reform agenda into action in the classroom. It provides teachers with clear content, performance, and learning competencies for each subject and grade level (DepEd, 2024). The guide suggests dividing the curriculum into

quarters and includes example tasks to make the previous K to 12 curriculum less cluttered. It also says that communicative competence, critical thinking, and cultural relevance should be the main learning goals.

Recent qualitative studies highlight that, while the MATATAG guide enhances clarity and focus, its efficacy depends on teachers' interpretations and adaptations in real classrooms. According to Malinao and Miano (2025), educators actively contextualize and enhance the guide's competencies to accommodate learner diversity and address gaps. They often reorganize content and create new activities to ensure lessons stay relevant and engaging. Berecio et al., (2025) stated that differentiated instruction guided by the curriculum needed to reach various students. However, problems remain, such as a lack of training and materials.

According to Bejasa (2025) and Torrefiel et al., (2025), a phenomenological research design was used to examine how teachers' experiences with the curriculum guide are shaped by its structural strengths and weaknesses. Transparent learning progressions are a benefit. Heightened workload and the need for ongoing professional development are challenges. Belga et al., (2025) support these findings. They emphasize that the guide's success depends on ongoing institutional support and on teacher autonomy in adapting standards to local contexts.

In conclusion, the curriculum guide aims to simplify and streamline the instruction. However, teachers' ability to facilitate, adapt, and innovate within the provided framework will ultimately decide its impact. This dynamic underscore the need for ongoing support, resources, and training to ensure reforms deliver real gains in student learning.

MATATAG English Curriculum

The MATATAG English Curriculum was intended to address the weaknesses of the old K-12 system by prioritizing more straightforward, powerful core literacies. As stated by Gaudicos et al., (2024) and Kilag et al., (2024), MATATAG is designed to provide a practical, learner-focused

framework that incorporates Philippine values with global standards. According to Alvarado (2023), English teaching focuses on communicative competence, critical thinking, and contextual language, all of which are vital skills for 21st-century learners. Origenes (2025) noted that Grade 7 is an essential developmental phase for improving reading, writing, and oral skills, which aligns with the objective of MATATAG to seal the learning gaps at the foundational stage. It is on these principles that MATATAG accepts teachers as key agents of change who translate curriculum designs into classroom practice.

Empirical studies indicate that there are persistent discrepancies between the objectives of reform and classroom practices. Abaiz et al., (2024) and Elardo (2025) discovered that improvisation is one of the strategies many English teachers apply because they lack sufficient preparation time and resources. According to Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025), although teachers are eager to adopt communicative pedagogy, excessive workload and unclear assessment criteria prevent them from adhering to the entire curriculum. This fact demonstrates that commitment is not enough to address systemic problems in institutional support and professional growth.

Initial enthusiasm declined over time. Lagbao (2024) noted general approval of the MATATAG streamlined structure, but this was later followed by a loss of confidence as challenges in task management and insufficient training became clear. It reflects a typical pattern in education reform and strong beginnings marked by enthusiasm, followed by slow progress and limited long-term change.

Although the studies differ in their methods, they agree on several key points. Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) used qualitative research to explore how teachers adapt their strategies when faced with limited resources. In contrast, Gumilao and Langam (2025) applied pretest-posttest designs to determine professional learning outcomes. Aquino (2024) added an assessment model for classroom alignment. Despite these advancements, research remains insufficient. There have

only been a few long-term or results-based studies that have looked at how the reform affects literacy. Without regular evaluations that link Grade 7 English teaching to student progress, MATATAG might not last long and might be more about politics than about making a real difference in the education system.

Comparisons with other Asian countries in the ASEAN back this review. Indraprasta and Pawiro (2023) describe how the Merdeka and Independent curricula in Indonesia have instituted teacher feedback loops and retraining mechanisms to sustain reforms. (Lahiya et al., 2025) emphasize that professional development in Vietnam has been gradually developed over the years with government support, and that Singapore has built evaluation cycles into its reform, making them essential to successful reform. On the other hand, the system of governance instability in the Philippines, its decentralization, and the fragmentation of funding pose a threat to the sustainability of the reform and the development of teacher capacity.

To sum up, the MATATAG English Curriculum encompasses good ideas, with a more student-centered approach and a clearer focus on skills. The main obstacle is bridging the gap between what the curriculum aims to achieve and what actually happens in classrooms, which will require ongoing teacher development, institutional support, and careful tracking of progress through performance-based measures. Important steps include providing teachers with protected time to plan, establishing regular feedback cycles, and encouraging teamwork through peer observation. How Grade 7 English teachers respond to these efforts will help determine whether MATATAG can result in long-lasting change or merely replicate previous reform patterns.

Teacher's Role in Curriculum Implementation

Teachers play an important role in carrying out the curriculum, serving as the bridge between national policy and classroom practice. According to Katshuna and Shikalepo (2023), reforms are rarely followed exactly as planned; teachers often adjust to fit their classrooms and

meet the needs of diverse students. Similarly, Alvarado and Galigao (2024) argue that the success of reform depends on teachers' capacity to reconcile official standards with students' immediate needs. Teacher agency is one of the essentials for realizing the reform. The Philippines' MATATAG curriculum supports this idea but also reveals ongoing challenges. Loza (2024) found that although teachers preferred a simpler design for MATATAG, many lacked training to use it effectively.

According to Batonghinog and Chavez (2025), teacher confidence and adherence to curriculum standards are strongly influenced by ongoing professional development and institutional support. Rather than relying solely on individual efforts, training institutions must take the lead in providing structured, consistent training programs to ensure effective implementation. Caballero et al., (2025) found that teachers, especially those working in inclusive classrooms, face challenges such as limited resources and diverse student needs. Their study shows that institutional support and available resources directly affect student achievement. Jamero and Accad (2025) reported a strong positive relationship ($r = 0.694$, $p < 0.01$) between administrative support and teacher effectiveness. This suggests that teacher motivation and instructional quality improve through structured mentoring and ongoing training. Overall, the research confirms that teacher skills are closely linked to student performance in reading and communication, aligning with the goals of the MATATAG English Curriculum.

Teachers' ability to modify, accommodate, and adapt their instruction plays a crucial role in ensuring faithful curriculum implementation and enhancing student achievement in Grade 7 English classrooms. Hanum and Dalimunte (2025) demonstrated that the Indonesia Merdeka Curriculum provided teachers with autonomy and feedback, which enhanced the continuous enhancement of teaching. Vietnam reformed gradually, supported by ongoing training, whereas Singapore incorporated curriculum review and evaluation into its governance to ensure uniformity. In contrast, education reforms in the Philippines are marked by political instability, uneven funding,

and decentralization, which make it difficult to maintain consistent teacher training and regular monitoring. Several studies support these findings. Demate et al., (2025) found that teachers used collaborative strategies to manage challenges in implementing MATATAG, demonstrating professional flexibility. Monton and Ducot (2025) reported that strong leadership and frequent supervision improved the teaching of competencies. However, there is still a lack of long-term research linking these practices to measurable gains in students' reading, writing, and speaking skills.

In conclusion, teachers act as both instructional leaders and cultural mediators, linking the goals of the MATATAG Curriculum to daily classroom teaching. Their success depends on regular training, clear school policies, and strong support from school leaders. However, problems with the system have dampened initial enthusiasm, and there are still few studies tracking long-term results. To fill these gaps, teachers need ongoing training and regular evaluations to see if Grade 7 English lessons under MATATAG truly lead to lasting improvements in student learning.

Challenges In Implementing Curriculum Reforms

The challenges teachers face in adapting to curriculum changes have been a topic of concern at both the local and global levels. Teachers experienced challenges in the previous reforms, including K-12, which continued despite policy changes. Casimiro et al., (2021) found that high workloads and insufficient training weaken teachers' capacity to maintain student engagement. Similarly, Abdullah et al., (2025) stated that English teachers experienced resource shortages and overcrowded lessons, leading them to resort to improvisation rather than planned lessons. Aslam et al., (2024) and Karakuş (2021) reported that a loaded curriculum, poor professional education, and inadequate institutional support are failures in the implementation process.

The same problems can be found under the MATATAG Curriculum, but in different forms. Loza (2024) found that teachers simplified standards; however, many were unsure how to implement them without ongoing training. Elardo (2025) reported an imbalance in teacher preparation due to the absence of specialized development programs and guidelines. According to Maraveles and Ducot (2025), teachers were unable to achieve the reform goals due to heavy workloads and limited classroom resources. As noted by Cruz et al., (2025), these pressures increased stress levels, reducing motivation and teaching energy. Jelongos and Naanep (2025) stated that high workloads and reduced classroom engagement are trends that hinder student development. These results indicate that the barriers are not only due to practical constraints but also to institutional gaps in support and policy implementation. Possible solutions were illuminated through comparative studies.

Internationally, the reform and national retraining in Vietnam were conducted in advance. The implementation was maintained by the continuous review cycles and accountability systems in Singapore. Hanum and Dalimunte (2025) found that feedback loops and retraining are incorporated into the Merdeka Curriculum in Indonesia to enable teachers to adapt. Compared to this, political changes, lopsided decentralization, and the lack of organized funding still threaten the reform process in the Philippines. These boundaries force educators to work with minimal support, leaving them burnt out and resorting to short-term, unsustainable solutions. These institutional inadequacies have first-order consequences on students. Literacy, especially in reading comprehension and communication, remains low in the Philippines.

In situations with high teacher stress, limited teacher preparation, and minimal resources, classroom engagement is reduced and learning is impaired. The MATATAG curriculum aims to enhance literacy and communication, and it would otherwise be incomplete and deficient without constant surveillance and data analysis. There is the problem of cultural and linguistic diversity.

Torrefiel et al., (2025) found that teachers in multilingual, rural schools are frequently deprived of resources to meet students' background requirements. Similarly, Hatmanto and Rahmawati (2023) stated that without proper training, teachers struggle to meet diverse learning needs, potentially creating gaps between urban and rural learners. These findings highlight the importance of linguistic inclusivity and cultural awareness in implementing the MATATAG Curriculum to ensure fair access to education.

Recent studies by Bazar (2025) and Torrefiel et al., (2025) are limited in duration; they yield qualitative data on teachers' experiences and adaptation strategies. Jamero and Accad (2025) conducted a quantitative study that pinpointed essential school and leadership factors affecting implementation. Malinao and Miano (2025) used a mixed-methods approach; their results require additional validation. In general, not many studies have looked at reforms over a long period of time or found clear links between the problems teachers face and improvements in student learning that can be measured. When used effectively, these strategies help improve reading, writing, and speaking skills, which are key areas of literacy in the MATATAG Curriculum. In the Philippines, regional examples offer valuable insights for educational development.

Bucal and Pawilen (2025) advise that responsive teaching techniques are needed to ensure Indigenous learners are incorporated in the MATATAG Curriculum. Unless lessons and instruction are adjusted to local contexts, English instruction may give urban and English-speaking students an unfair advantage over those in multilingual contexts. In this situation, teachers mediate cultural aspects rather than strictly follow the curriculum, and they can help bridge the gap between language and context that influences student learning. Although studies present various strategies, they also share common insights into the relevance of inclusive, context-sensitive teaching structures. Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) provide qualitative evidence of adaptive literacy practices, while Cape and Subillaga (2025) offer quantitative proof that grammar-

integrated lessons improve performance. Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) employ a mixed-methods approach to investigate the relationship between teaching styles and students' motivation and communication skills. However, only a few long-term or results-based studies examine lasting progress in literacy. Without strong evaluation that links teaching methods to clear learning outcomes, the success of reforms often relies more on opinions than on proven results.

In conclusion, effective English instruction under the MATATAG Curriculum requires the use of communicative, context-based, and culturally responsive methods that follow curriculum standards. Teaching has shifted from inconsistent K–12 practices to more flexible, student-focused approaches. However, strong institutional support remains important. To apply best practices, it is recommended to establish formal teacher retraining programs, build stable governance systems, and incorporate regular evaluation processes. To bridge the research gap, the impact of teaching changes should be measured in long-term studies funded. These steps offer a good roadmap for moving adaptive teaching from a temporary feature to a permanent part of the teaching process.

Teaching Practices in English Instruction

Curriculum goals are shaped by how teachers teach in the classroom, which in turn affects how well students learn to read and write. In the old K–12 curriculum, teaching was not the same for all students. Cabrera et al., (2023) discovered that the reading lessons lacked clear continuity, leaving gaps in students' knowledge. As mentioned by Tumala (2024), the strict spiral progression acted as an impediment to allowing the teacher to adjust the lesson to various levels of skills. The findings highlight that MATATAG needs to change to student-centered, competency-based instruction with emphasis on actual mastery. Based on this requirement, recent studies on MATATAG implementation show that adaptive instructional practices align with English curriculum objectives. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) found that oral/silent reading enhanced understanding and interest among Grade 7 students. According to Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025), teachers

resorted to scaffolding and group work to train readers. In contrast, Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) emphasize the importance of collaborative learning and real-life communication activities to develop fluency. Cape and Subillaga (2025) verify that the introduction of grammar teaching to the literature lessons increased the accuracy and comprehension of language.

Combined, the practices are an indication of a transition towards communication-oriented practices that are integrated and align with the standards of MATATAG. Ambitious ideas, inconsistent execution, and constant shifts have marked the Philippines' curriculum reform. All the reforms, such as the K-12 program and the present MATATAG Curriculum, represent the nation's ongoing efforts to enhance education and address historical gaps in teacher training, governing policies, and student performance. The K to 12 reform, regarded as a significant change, was diluted by flaws in its organization and a lack of competence in its implementation (Malbas et al., 2023). As observed by Barrot (2023), excessive content and a lack of teacher preparation undermined the purpose of developing future-ready learners.

These problems contributed to the corrective change. DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024 introduced the MATATAG Curriculum. It will streamline competencies, eliminate redundancies, and harmonize learning objectives with the lifelong learning core competencies. Estrellado (2023) mentioned one of the primary improvements in MATATAG, decongestion, and emphasized that it was aimed at reducing overload on the content, returning teaching to core skills, and providing teachers with more time to develop students' reading and communication skills.

According to Diquito (2024), there were initial improvements in the clarity of subjects, particularly science, with more competent classrooms leading to increased focus in teaching and improved alignment of goals and classroom tests. Similarly, Kilag et al., (2024) found that MATATAG is a significant advancement in K-12 education, with its learner-centered, context-based content being more specific and flexible to classroom teaching needs. However, reforms in the Philippine

education system have tended to be influenced by political changes rather than regularly reviewed based on evidence. The long-term success of MATAG will presumably rely on mechanisms of continuous evaluation, excellent teacher education, and policy continuity across leadership transitions. The current available studies on curriculum change in the Philippines are general and differ in quality and depth. According to Aguas (2020), the success of reform depends on how teachers and school leaders understand and implement policy objectives in their schools. Nengasca (2025) also emphasized that successful implementation requires proper direction, continuous encouragement, and alignment between policy objectives and classroom practice. A combination of these studies reveals that teachers attempt to support reform, but gaps in training and coordination prevent its uniform application across schools. On the system level, Barrot (2019) and Galaura and Simpal (2025) provide helpful information, although their results are primarily descriptive. Barrot (2019) detected continuous breaks in the flow of subjects, correspondence between assessment and teaching, and coherence, and (Galaura and Simpal 2025) attributed poorer teaching quality to the scarcity of resources and excessive workload. Nevertheless, they both relied on cross-sectional data, which limits their ability to track long-term learning outcomes.

This research trend matters because it shows we need to keep checking, using real data, to see if reforms like MATATAG are helping students improve. However, national and regional assessments such as PISA (2018) and SEA-PLM indicate that the Philippines continues to underperform in literacy and numeracy, suggesting that there remains a gap between the objectives of reform and significant learning outcomes. Although reforms such as K-12 and MATATAG have been implemented, students' reading and writing scores remain among the lowest worldwide, particularly in Grade 7 English. On the whole, these results indicate the absence of long-term, evidence-based systems that would link curriculum changes to actual gains in literacy, forcing policymakers to rely on aggregated national data rather than classroom outcomes.

In Southeast Asia, the MATATAG Curriculum aligns with regional trends toward adaptable learning models and competency-based learning. Merdeka Curriculum of Indonesia focuses on teacher autonomy, teaching in context, and continuous professional development to enhance literacy and communication (Indraprasta and Pawiro, 2023). Vietnam implemented its reform in steps, backed by ongoing teacher development, so that the reform would be ready before implementation. Singapore works through regular curriculum reviews that incorporate assessment data to ensure policy and practice are aligned. These local cases demonstrate that reform can be successfully implemented only with the support of a stable government, sustained financing, and effective oversight. Conclusively, the MATATAG Curriculum is a reaction to the overindulgence of the K to 12 program, where more content is cut, learning becomes relevant, and teachers are empowered as the main reform measures.

In conclusion, with the current lapses in teacher training, classroom management, and political stability, its success continues to be jeopardized. A lack of long-term, outcome-based information and a poorly defined evaluation system limit attempts to assess whether MATATAG enhances literacy, particularly in English. The reform should be evidence-based, built on teacher development and institutional support, and designed to deliver actual outcomes for policymakers. Also, Grade 7 English teachers, being the primary connection between policy and classroom practice, will determine whether the teaching goals of MATAG result in observable improvements in student learning and communication skills.

Adaptations And Instructional Innovations by the Teachers

The literacy curriculum should be achieved through the application of practical teaching areas. The K-12 system has negatively affected student learning performance due to the lack of instructional practices. Cabrera et.al., (2023) found that reading instruction often lacked progression, which reduced learners' performance. According to Tumala (2024), adherence to a

spiral progression prevented teachers from attending to learners of different abilities. These results highlight the importance of applying the MATATAG Curriculum through skills-based, student-centered instruction that emphasizes mastery.

Recent reports on the MATATAG Curriculum show that flexible teaching methods align with the objectives of the English curriculum. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) discovered that oral and silent reading helped Grade 7 students better comprehend and participate in the process. Similarly, Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) find that scaffolded reading conditions and group research enhanced students' reading. In addition, Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) have highlighted the importance of team learning and activities for gaining fluency. According to Cape and Subillaga (2025), grammar practice incorporated into the lessons improved understanding and accuracy. Such solutions are a sign of a shift towards integrated teaching strategies that adhere to the MATATAG standards. The strategies will be useful for enhancing reading comprehension, writing fluency, and oral communication, as part of the fundamental literacy competencies of the MATATAG Curriculum, when effectively executed.

Internationally, Indonesia's Merdeka Curriculum teacher feedback helps improve instruction (Hanum and Dalimunte, 2025). Vietnam's reform focuses on implementing national retraining, while Singapore relies on continuous assessment to shape its curriculum. On the other hand, there are still some issues in the Philippines regarding decentralization, political transfers, and teacher financing. To overcome these issues and ensure the long-term success of the MATATAG Curriculum, one can create professional development courses, establish a school-wide feedback process to improve the work, and ensure a stable budget for long-term professional support for teachers and motivation. The steps can be used to enable effective, homogeneous teaching across different learning environments. Cultural and language contexts also determine instruction. According to Bucal and Pawilen (2025), employing Indigenous learners in MATATAG

must take into account practices that do not disrespect local cultures to be effectively inclusive. In the absence of such adaptation, the English classes will serve the interests of urban, English-dominant pupils at the expense of rural or bilingual pupils. In this position, teachers act as cultural guides, helping link language and context to make the learning process more meaningful for students.

Although these studies use different methods, they share key insights. (Gulmayo and Subillaga, 2025) provide qualitative data on adaptive literacy practices, but quantitative data on grammar-integrated lessons as less effective are provided by Cape and Subillaga (2025). Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) use a mixed-methods approach to examine the relationships among teaching styles, student motivation, and communication skills. Nevertheless, few long-term outcome studies follow literacy outcomes. The success of reform is more dependent on perception than on evidence, unless a large-scale evaluation is carried out that can associate the teaching method with measurable changes.

In conclusion, the MATATAG Curriculum aims to achieve effective English instruction through teaching methods that focus on communication, context, and culture, aligned with curriculum standards. Teaching has shifted from fragmented K–12 models to more adaptive, student-centered approaches, but strong institutional support remains essential. Best practices have to be incorporated to do this; therefore, formal teacher retraining programs have to be established, stable governance structures have to be developed, and systems of continuous assessment have to be incorporated. To seal the gap, long-term research is needed to trace the effects of instructional innovations. These measures provide an easy road to adapting teaching as one of the long-lasting aspects of development in the teaching field.

Impact Of Teachers' Adaptations on Classroom Instruction and Learning

Teachers' adaptations are key to connecting the intended curriculum to the final learning outcomes. In the MATATAG Curriculum, these changes affect how reforms are implemented in the classroom and how students respond to instruction. According to Cachero (2025), teachers' ability to adapt teaching strategies to local needs greatly influences how well students stay engaged and understand the lessons. Similarly, Balansag et al. (2024) conclude that flexible teaching methods led to measurable improvements in student performance. It shows that education policies can be translated into classroom practice when teachers are flexible and aware of their teaching context.

When teachers adapt their instruction to students' needs, they improve lesson delivery and support literacy in English instruction. Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) discovered that differences in reading methods and applicable lessons increased comprehension and engagement among Grade 7 students. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) stated that combining oral and silent reading was more effective in developing fluency. Also, Lipom et al., (2025) identified that using technology in lessons was more motivating. These results highlight the shift of the curriculum to digital and student-centered learning. Their combined demonstration is that adaptive techniques increase interaction and literacy. Additionally, teachers' flexibility makes instruction robust despite restrictions.

Saro et al. (2024) point out that teachers' role is to interpret the curriculum based on students' needs and resources and to modify the pacing and structure. Bergado and Ventura (2025) found that a growth mindset and resilience enable teachers to remain effective when the workload is heavy. As Po (2025) demonstrates, a lack of training and support can be compensated for by adaptation. The studies support these findings, showing that adaptation serves both as a coping strategy and as a means of keeping teaching aligned with learning goals.

Adaptation is directly related to student engagement and achievement. Cerezo et al., (2025) found that students who received modified, relevant instruction performed better on written and hands-on tasks. Uy et al., (2024) found that literacy and numeracy improved when teachers used materials relevant to students' lives. Marzo and Velasco (2025) observed that there existed a close correlation between improved performance ratings and the adaptive skills of teachers. These findings show that adaptive teaching improves learning quality and enhances classroom dynamics. However, the distinction between adaptations and official standards depends on the situation.

According to Po (2025) it may result in unequal curriculum implementation and unequal student achievement. Competencies are simplified or modified by teachers in an attempt to save time (Cachero, 2025). It says that although the teacher's freedom fosters innovation, careless monitoring and guidance may prompt the teacher to act beyond the intended goal, and that the arguments for the necessity of clear frameworks that balance flexibility and adherence to curriculum objectives are compelling.

To sum up, teachers' adaptation of the MATATAG Curriculum influences their success, engagement levels, and teaching quality. Teachers incorporate policy into practice by modifying standards, differentiating lessons, and adopting new approaches, which influence the level and quality of English learning, particularly in comprehension, writing fluency, and communication fluency.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

The implementation of the MATATAG English curriculum falls within the cross-section of educational changes that focus on systemic and classroom-level change. The theories employed in this research will describe the process by which teachers negotiate the complex orders of such reforms and implement curriculum policies in practice. To gain clearer insight into the challenges, practices, and strategies of transition, the research will also draw on two complementary theories:

Fullan's Change Theory and Shulman's Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) Framework. The appropriateness of these ideas captures the dimensions of curriculum implementation in systemic and organizational contexts, which are regularly shaped by teacher adaptation and by instructional knowledge that drives classroom-level practices.

Fullan's Change Theory

Michael Fullan's conceptual idea is anchored on the premise of system-oriented curriculum reforms. This lens discusses educational change in nonlinear ways and is complex, requiring the deliberate alignment of teacher capacity, school culture, and leadership (Fullan, 2007). The success of reforms in the educational process, therefore, is highly determined by three interrelated factors: building teacher capacity through continuous professional learning, supplying resources and organizational support, and a culture of collaboration that makes teachers agents of change. Teachers in this level are not mere implementers but active professionals who shape and interpret the curricular directives in their classroom contexts.

Capacity building accordingly involves the deliberate development of teachers' skills, knowledge, and professional dispositions to meet new demands in the profession (Fullan, 2007). Professional development, access to resources, and time allocation are important inclusions. In the MATATAG curriculum transition program, capacity-building is essential to the effective design and implementation of the curriculum.

Teacher Agency and Moral Purpose, on the other hand, talks about the role of teachers as active participants and interpreters of reform. They cannot be just passive followers of the policy (Biesta et al., 2015). The agency occurs when educators make decisions regarding the conduct of the lessons, serving various learners, and producing contextual materials. It is essential for investigating teachers' implementation practices during the transition to MATATAG. The teacher agency ensures that the implementation of the curriculum does not cut across all

teachers, while remaining aware of the requirements of various learners. Lastly, the contextual and organizational conditions address the change that has been incorporated into the school's culture, leadership, and collaboration. (Fullan, 2007) explains that leaders who support and create a culture of collaboration mediate sustainable reforms. It is connected to the way school managers can recognize issues in curriculum support and implementation. Some significant obstacles in this regard include a lack of leadership support, pressure from the workload, and poor coordination. These concepts should be addressed early in the implementation of the curriculum. Fullan's theory helps explain the challenges teachers face in curriculum implementation. It also justifies the need for systemic strategies in designing a transition program. However, the theory does not capture the dimensions of teaching—the actual practices through which teachers deliver content. Therefore, a second theory is needed.

Pedagogical Content Knowledge

Lee Shulman's concept of Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) highlights that effective teaching goes beyond mastery of the subject matter. Accordingly, teachers must be able to transform content into comprehensible input for learners. It encompasses the selection of examples, the forecasting of student myths, and the decision on how an instruction should be adapted to accommodate the needs of diverse students (Lee Shing et al., 2013). The framework studies teachers' use of curriculum in classroom learning. The theory assumptions used in this study will be content knowledge, Pedagogical knowledge, and Pedagogical content knowledge.

Content knowledge (CK) -deals with the mastery of the subject matter itself. Teachers with deep CK can accurately represent their subject's content and respond to their students' needs (Lee Shing et al., 2013). PCK assumes that good teaching starts with the blend of content knowledge and pedagogical understanding of how to utilize this content. In the teaching of English, providing comprehensible input and knowledge of grammar, vocabulary, syntax, literary genres,

communication, and discourse conventions is crucial. Teachers ought to have a strong command of the concepts to impart knowledge and determine their students' needs. Without solid content knowledge, the most creative teaching paradigm would lead to misrepresentation of subject matter. It leads to student misconceptions and superficial learning.

Pedagogical Knowledge (PK) - This is the teacher's broad knowledge of the teaching and learning process. Learning theories, classroom management, instructional strategies, and assessment methods are very fundamental and require deep knowledge to provide instruction.

(Lee Shing et al., 2013; Phillips, 2014). For teachers transitioning to the new curriculum, PK is demonstrated through the design of learning environments that foster motivation, effective management of diverse classroom behaviours, and adaptation of instruction to varied learning styles and needs. PK provides an understanding of the "how" of teaching by ensuring lessons are delivered in ways that promote engagement and deep learning.

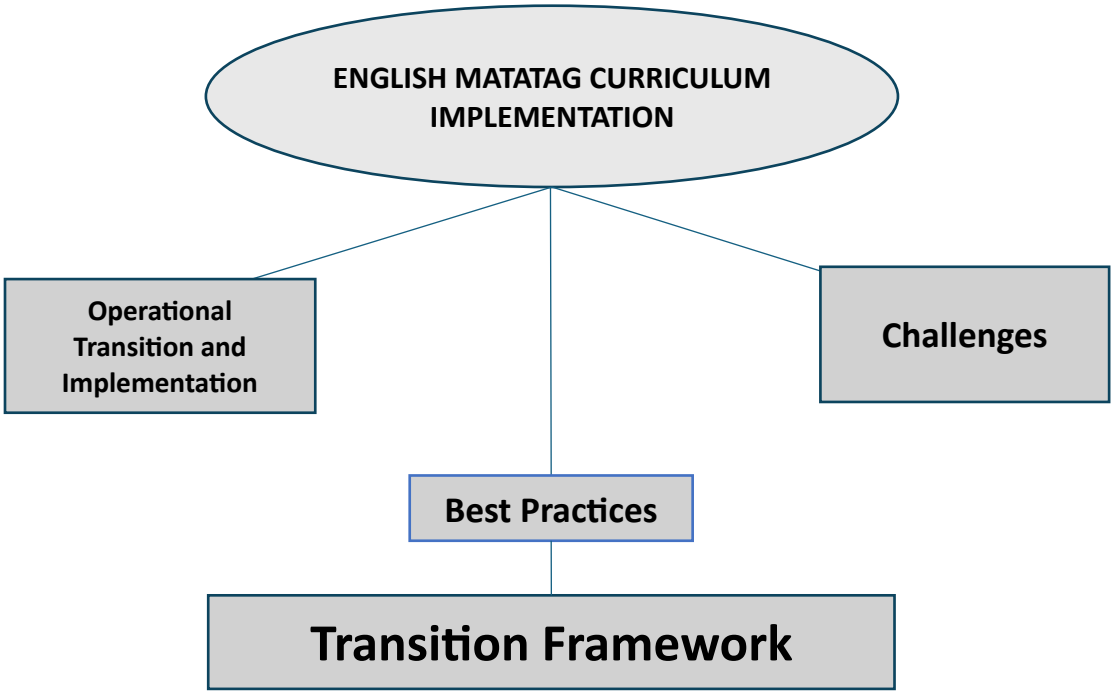
Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) - This is the overlap between CK and PK, including the distinctive knowledge that a teacher, as an expert in the field of subject matter, brings to students who have not undergone any teaching training (Lee Shing et al, 2013). Knowledge of the content and the ways to convey lessons is PCK. Content is reformatted for learners to read and comprehend. The subject matter is converted into easily accessible, comprehensible forms for learners. It involves arriving at the illusion of misconceptions, choosing the right illustrations, and adapting explanations according to the levels of the learners. PCK is evolving and adapting, providing experience and professional growth because teachers never cease to examine their practices.

In summary, content knowledge provides the "what", pedagogical knowledge is the "how", and pedagogical content knowledge integrates the two concepts and answers the "how to teach the specific content to specific individuals". For this research, the effective implementation

of the MATATAG curriculum is based not only on the teacher's mastery of English but also on the ability to select appropriate strategies, anticipate needs, and create meaningful experiences.

In essence, Fullan's theory provides a macro-level understanding of reform and systemic processes. Meanwhile, PCK, as defined by Shulman, provides a micro-level description of how teachers implement changes in their everyday activities. The theories used together provide a comprehensive perspective on the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum, as they reflect the structural impediments and teaching practices that shape English instruction in the Philippine basic education department.

1.4 Schematic Diagram



1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study aims to explore the Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide among Grade 7 English teachers. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following objectives:

1. To identify the challenges encountered by Grade 7 English Teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.
2. To describe the operational transition and implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum guide in their classroom instruction.
3. To identify the best teaching practices of Grade 7 English Teachers in catering to the diverse needs of students while following the curriculum guide.
4. To propose a transition framework that best aligns with implementation practices for teachers in classroom instruction.

1.6. Scope and Limitations

This study focuses on Grade 7 English teachers implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide in selected empowered public and private secondary schools located in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. It examines their practices, challenges, and adaptations during the School Year 2024–2025. The scope will be limited to the identified research sites, and any other grade levels, subjects, or schools beyond the set parameters will not be involved. Any issues about students' performance, school management, or other subjects will not be covered. Teachers' experiences implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum guide will be the main focus. The information will be gathered through interviews and classroom observations. The research location will be selected purposively by the researchers, based on convenience and proximity, thereby enabling firsthand, concrete information on the application of the MATATAG English Curriculum.

1.7 Definition of Terms

To ensure conceptual precision and clarity in the use of these terms, which are operationally defined for this study, the following terms were used:

Challenges. Refer to the measurable and context-specific barriers that hinder Grade 7 English teachers from effectively implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.

Curriculum: A systematic collection of learning standards, learning competencies, and learning objectives that help to direct the teaching and learning. This paper has been relevant to the model that teachers apply in planning and delivering English instruction in accordance with the MATATAG reform.

Curriculum Guide. Refers to the formal document of the Department of Education that defines the learning competencies, content standards, and performance standards of every subject. It is

the primary source for Grade 7 English teachers to adopt lessons aligned with the MATATAG Curriculum.

Curriculum Implementation. Means the process through which Grade 7 English teachers can be observed to be systematic and convert competencies, standards, and pedagogical intentions of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide into actual classroom practice.

Instructional Practices. Refer to the detailed teaching methods and classroom practices of the teachers to meet the learning goals of the MATATAG English Curriculum, with the focus on communicative competence and literacy development.

K to 12 Curriculum. Refers to the former Philippine national curriculum, which was used to improve basic education by adding more grades and spiral development. It will be used in the study as a reference point for identifying gaps and the improvements the MATATAG Curriculum has addressed.

MATATAG Curriculum. Describes the redesigned curriculum brought in by DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024, with a focus on decongested learning standards, foundational literacy, and contextualised instruction. It is the main issue of discussion in this research.

MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. Specifically, to the English element of the MATATAG Curriculum, which identifies the competencies and the anticipated learning outcomes of Grade 7 English. It forms the basis for teachers' planning and delivery.

Teacher Adaptation. Means the planned instructional changes, contextual adaptations, as well as new practices that Grade 7 English teachers use to make sure that the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide is effective. Teacher adaptation in this paper includes the ways teachers restructure lessons, differentiate teaching methods, and design localised learning resources in response to the needs of diverse learners, scarce or limited teaching resources, and institutional factors.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter will present the research design, research locale, participants, research instruments, data-gathering procedures, data analysis plan, and ethical considerations. These components will describe the systematic process that will guide the conduct of the study entitled *"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."*

2.1 Research Design

This study will use a descriptive qualitative research design to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. Qualitative research focuses on understanding the meanings individuals or groups give to their experiences by collecting data in natural settings and analyzing them inductively to identify patterns and themes. This design will be appropriate because the study will aim to describe teachers' challenges, practices, and adaptations in applying the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide in real classroom contexts.

Within this qualitative approach, the study specifically will apply the descriptive method, which will involve careful examination of data with limited interpretation. This method will organize participants' responses into themes that reflect their actual experiences. This approach will allow the study to describe what teachers will do, how they will implement the curriculum, and the factors that will influence their instructional practices.

The descriptive qualitative design will highlight participants' authentic perspectives using their own words. It will rely on interviews, classroom observations, and document analysis to gain an in-depth understanding of teachers' experiences. Instead of testing hypotheses, the study will organize participants' responses into meaningful themes that will explain how the curriculum will be implemented and adapted in practice.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The primary research instrument will be a structured interview guide containing open-ended questions. The interview guide will be developed by the researchers and will be validated by experts in curriculum studies and English education to ensure clarity and relevance. To enhance the credibility of the data, the researchers will use follow-up questions during the interviews to clarify participants' responses and ensure their experiences are accurately captured.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

Research Locale

The study will be conducted in selected empowered public and private secondary schools located in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. The schools that will be conducted are those that follow the MATATAG Curriculum guide.

Research Respondents

The participants will be Grade 7 English teachers teaching under the MATATAG English Curriculum in the selected public and private secondary schools. The study will involve 17 teachers from 12 empowered secondary schools who will have direct experience in implementing the curriculum.

Table 1

Participants of the Study

Municipality	School	Teachers
Buenavista	Saint James High School	3
	Buenavista Special Education High School	1
	Buenavista National High School	1
	Buenavista Institute	1
Nasipit	Saint Michael College of Caraga	1
	Nasipit National Vocational School	4
	Northwestern Agusan Colleges	1
	Calixto D. Montinola National High School	1
	Culit National High School	1
Carmen	Carmen National High School	1
	Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga Incorporated	1
	Cahayagan National High School	1

Research Sampling

The study will use purposive sampling, selecting participants based on their direct involvement in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. Participants must have at least two years of teaching experience and have attended DepEd MATATAG training programs. This sampling method will be appropriate because it will allow the selection of individuals who will provide relevant and firsthand insights aligned with the research objectives.

Research Instrument

The researchers will use a structured interview guide as the main instrument for data collection. The interview guide will contain organized open-ended questions developed by the researchers and validated by experts to ensure clarity and relevance to the study. The questions will be designed to encourage participants to share their challenges, practices, and adaptations in implementing the MATATAG Curriculum Guide.

During the interviews, the researchers will employ probing questions to elicit detailed explanations and examples from participants, allowing for a deeper understanding of their experiences. Responses will be carefully recorded and transcribed verbatim to ensure accuracy. The researchers will then analyze the data thematically, identifying patterns, commonalities, and variations in the participants' experiences, which will provide a comprehensive understanding of the implementation of the MATATAG Curriculum Guide.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Data Gathering Procedure

Creswell and Creswell (2022) explain that qualitative data gathering follows systematic steps that include securing institutional approval, ensuring ethical participation, collecting data in natural settings, accurately recording information, and protecting participants' rights throughout the research process. Guided by these principles, this study will follow a structured and ethical data gathering procedure to ensure the credibility and trustworthiness of the findings.

The researchers will prepare data collection by fulfilling all institutional, ethical, and logistical requirements. Approval letters will be obtained from the Dean of the College of Teacher Education Department and the principals of the selected schools. A separate authorization letter will be sent to the principals or head teachers to request permission to conduct the study within their schools. These documents will be included in the Appendices.

Written informed consent will be obtained from all participants. The consent forms will clearly explain:

- The purpose and objectives of the study
- Procedures involved in the research

- Potential risks and benefits
- Participants' rights, including the choice of audio-only or audio + video recording
- The right to withdraw at any time without penalty

Participants will be given sufficient time to review the interview guide, ask questions, and clarify any concerns before the interview. Logistical arrangements will be made to ensure smooth, reliable, and ethical data collection. Interviews will be conducted in a quiet environment, and recording devices will be tested beforehand to prevent data loss. The researchers will adhere strictly to all preparatory and ethical procedures during the data gathering process. All interviews will be recorded according to participants' preferences (audio-only or audio + video) and later transcribed verbatim. Transcripts will be analyzed systematically using ATLAS.ti software, which will assist in organizing, coding, and identifying emerging themes from the data.

Steps in Data Analysis:

1. **Familiarizing with the data:** The researchers will immerse themselves in the transcripts, reading and listening repeatedly to develop a comprehensive understanding. Early impressions and notes will be recorded in ATLAS.ti.
2. **Generating initial codes:** Using ATLAS.ti, significant segments of text will be coded, representing participants' ideas or patterns.
3. **Searching for themes:** Codes will be grouped into preliminary themes reflecting participants shared experiences and perspectives. Network and visualization tools in ATLAS.ti will assist in exploring relationships among codes.
4. **Reviewing potential themes:** Emerging themes will be checked against coded extracts and transcripts to ensure accuracy, consistency, and coherence. Redundant or weakly supported themes will be merged or modified.

5. **Defining and naming themes:** Each finalized theme will be clearly defined and labeled, with a thematic map and codebook created in ATLAS.ti.
6. **Writing up:** Themes will be integrated into a scholarly narrative that describes participants' experiences, challenges, practices, and adaptations. Direct quotations will support interpretations, and the report will provide a clear account of how the curriculum is applied in classrooms.

Post-Analysis Procedures:

All recordings, transcripts, and ATLAS.ti project files will be securely stored and password-protected to ensure ethical compliance, confidentiality, and data integrity.

Data Analysis

The researchers will use a descriptive qualitative design to conduct a thorough thematic analysis, following the steps outlined by Braun and Clarke (2006). This approach will be appropriate for describing teachers' experiences and practices using non-numerical data gathered through interviews and discussions. The participants' responses will be analyzed based on the guide questions, with each transcription from audio and video recordings carefully read to identify relevant statements. All relevant responses will be grouped and labeled according to identified themes. The transcripts will be uploaded to ATLAS.ti software—a qualitative analysis tool that will help systematically organize, code, and identify themes.

The researchers will follow these procedures:

Step 1: Familiarizing with the Data

All recorded interviews will be transcribed verbatim to preserve the authenticity of participants' responses. The researchers will immerse themselves in the data by repeatedly

reading and listening to the transcripts to develop a comprehensive understanding of their content. Through this familiarization process, the researchers will begin forming initial insights and annotations. Using ATLAS.ti, notes and early impressions will be systematically recorded to support later analysis.

Step 2: Generating Initial Codes

The researchers will use ATLAS.ti software to systematically code the transcripts by identifying significant segments of text. Each code will represent a concise description of ideas or patterns in participants' statements. These codes will serve as the foundation for identifying broader themes that align with the study's objectives regarding the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.

Step 3: Searching for Themes

After coding, similar or related codes will be grouped to form preliminary themes that will reflect participants' shared experiences and perspectives. ATLAS.ti network and visualization tools will help the researchers explore relationships among codes and develop an initial thematic structure. This process will allow patterns to emerge that reflect the core ideas underlying teachers' experiences, challenges, and practices.

Step 4: Reviewing Potential Themes

The researchers will review and refine the emerging themes to ensure accuracy, consistency, and coherence. Each theme will be checked against the coded extracts and the original transcripts to confirm that it accurately reflects participants' meanings. Redundant or overlapping themes will be merged, while those lacking sufficient support will be modified or removed. This process will ensure that the final themes remain grounded in the data.

Step 5: Defining and Naming Themes

The finalized themes will be clearly defined and named to capture their essence and relevance to the research questions. Each theme will be assigned a concise, descriptive label. These definitions and names will be recorded in a thematic map and codebook generated through ATLAS.ti, providing an overview of how each theme will connect to the study's broader narrative.

Step 6: Writing Up

The last phase will involve integrating the analyzed data into a comprehensive scholarly narrative that will describe the experiences of Grade 7 English teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. The researchers will present the themes alongside direct quotations from participants to support interpretations. The report will be organized around the identified themes—teachers' experiences, challenges, practices, and adaptations—offering a clear and descriptive account of how the curriculum will be applied in classroom contexts.

Post-Analysis Procedures:

All audio recordings, transcripts, and ATLAS.ti project files will be securely stored and password-protected to maintain ethical standards, transparency, and data integrity throughout the research process.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The study will not develop any new technology, process, or product requiring a patent. The researchers will honor intellectual property rights by ensuring that all materials used are properly referenced and credited according to copyright laws. No trademark registration is needed as no new brands, logos, or symbols will be created.

B. Informed Consent

Participants will be fully informed about the purpose, procedures, risks, and benefits of the study before data collection. Written consent will be obtained, ensuring voluntary participation. Participants will have the choice of audio-only or audio + video recording during interviews. Ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board will be secured prior to data collection.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The researchers will comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). Participant's identities will be protected using pseudonyms, and all information will be securely stored and accessible only to the research team. No identifiable information will be disclosed in publications or presentations.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom of Withdraw

Participation is voluntary, and participants may withdraw at any time without penalty. Researchers will ensure participants feel safe and comfortable, providing full support throughout the study.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The researchers will take steps to minimize potential risks, including emotional or psychological stress. Participants may pause, skip questions, or withdraw at any time. Support systems such as guidance counselors or the school clinic will be available if participants experience discomfort. Clear instructions, reassurance, and encouragement will be provided to ensure a safe and respectful process.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The study aims to provide valuable insights for administrators, teachers, and policymakers. Findings will inform the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide and support improvements in teaching strategies, curriculum application, and student learning outcomes.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants will be selected based on their relevance to the research objectives.

Inclusion criteria:

- Grade 7 English teachers currently implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum
- At least two years of teaching experience
- Exposure to DepEd MATATAG training programs

Exclusion criteria:

- Teachers not teaching Grade 7 English
- Less than two years of teaching experience
- No exposure to the MATATAG Curriculum or relevant training

Selection will be free from discrimination based on gender, religion, socioeconomic status, or institution.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researchers will ensure accuracy in gathering, transcribing, and analyzing interview data. Patterns will be identified by comparing responses among participants, which helps validate recurring themes. Possible limitations include:

- Participants' subjective perceptions and personal interpretations, which may influence responses
- Limited sample size, which may affect generalizability
- Potential researcher bias in interpreting qualitative data, mitigated through careful coding, peer consultation, and systematic thematic analysis using ATLAS.ti

All potential errors or limitations will be transparently acknowledged to maintain data integrity and ensure trustworthy results.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The researchers will report findings objectively, presenting both positive and negative results without omission, exaggeration, or misrepresentation.

- **Use of AI:** AI tools such as ChatGPT and Grammarly will only assist in drafting, editing, and checking linguistic accuracy. AI will not replace the researchers' critical thinking or analysis. All AI use will be fully disclosed in the methodology to ensure transparency. Data provided by participants will never be entered into unsafe AI platforms, and all AI-generated content will be manually verified.
- **Conflicts of Interest (COIs):** The researchers declare that no personal, financial, or professional conflicts of interest exist that could influence the study's design, data collection, analysis, or reporting. Any potential COIs will be disclosed immediately if they arise.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

All secondary sources and copyrighted materials will be properly cited, and permissions will be obtained as needed. This ensures transparency, attribution, and ethical use of materials.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The study involves only human participants and follows the Philippine National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Humans (DOST-PCHRD, 2017). No animals will be used.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies

AI tools will assist in drafting, editing, and linguistic checks only. Researchers will manually verify all AI-generated content to ensure accuracy and maintain ethical integrity. Participant data will not be entered into unsafe AI platforms.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

Ethical approval will be obtained from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC). Letters of authorization and consent will be secured from the Dean and school principals to ensure participant safety, confidentiality, and compliance with institutional requirements.

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ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
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November 05, 2025

ROSIBIEL ABAO
School Principal
Buenavista Institute
Poblacion 3, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Abao,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga,** currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

In line with this, we respectfully seek your approval to conduct research interviews with the Grade 7 English teacher/s in your esteemed school. We assure you that all data gathered will be handled with the utmost confidentiality and used solely for academic purposes. Upon approval, we will coordinate with your office to ensure proper scheduling and minimal disruption to regular class activities.

We sincerely hope for your favorable consideration of our request. Thank you very much for your time, we look forward to your positive response. If you have any questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact us at 09500735942 or via email at joecyl_montalban@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Respectfully yours,
JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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November 05, 2025

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Dear Ma'am Pinat,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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We sincerely hope for your favorable consideration of our request. Thank you very much for your time, we look forward to your positive response. If you have any questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact us at 09500735942 or via email at joecyl_montalban@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Respectfully yours,
JOECYL K. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

Noted by:

KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
ATUPAN ST., BRGY. 3, WAS PT. BUSAN DEL NORTE
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Date: 11-05-25 Time: 10:12 AM
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ARLYN A. PINAT
School Principal III

EARL JAMES A. LEYSON
Administrative Officer II
NOV 5, 2025

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SHERJ PHILIPPINES
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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
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November 05, 2025

MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Head
Buenavista Special Education High School
Poblacion 3, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rallos,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,
JOECYL K. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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ATUPAN ST., BRGY. 4, NASIPIT, AGUSAN DEL NORTE
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Date: 11-07-25 10:31 AM
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KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Head

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

November 05, 2025

MERLY P. ABIVA
School Principal
Saint James High School
Barangay 5, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Abiva,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,
JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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MERLY P. ABIVA
School Principal

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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November 06, 2025

RENE M. JAPITANA, MAEM
Basic High School School Principal
Saint Michael College of Caraga
Barangay 4, Atupan St., Nasipit, Agusan del norte

Dear Sir Japitana,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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Research Adviser

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RENE M. JAPITANA, MAEM
Basic High School School Principal

EMAIL : RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
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October 27, 2025

JONCHEL M. FRAN
School Principal I
Calixto D. Montinola Nation High School
Barangay 4, E. Felias St., Nasipit,
Agusan del Norte

Dear Sir Fran,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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JONCHEL M. FRAN
School Principal I

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SHERJ PHILIPPINES
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October 27, 2025

ELENITA S. VERDON, PhD
School Principal IV
Nasipit National Vocational School
Barangay 7, Nasipit, Agusan del norte

Dear Ma'am Verdon,

We are student researchers from Saint Michael College of Caraga, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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Date: 10-27-25
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KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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ELENITA S. VERDON, PhD
School Principal IV

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SHRI PHILIPPINES

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October 27, 2025

LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE -CAR
Head Teacher I
Culit National High School
District 2 Culit, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Oñate-Car,

We are student researchers from Saint Michael College of Caraga, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

Noted by:

KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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10/27/25

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LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE -CAR
Head Teacher I

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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October 27, 2025

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal
Our Lady of Carmen Academy of
Caraga Incorporated
General Luna St., Poblacion, Carmen,
Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rabino,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

Received and Approved by:

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal

merlitarabino2@gmail.com

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SHIFRJ PHILIPPINES

INNOVATION Center

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October 27, 2025

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV
Carmen National High School
Cabatuan, Carmen, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Pacon,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

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Noted by:

KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

Received and Approved by:

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV
10/27/25
7:14 PM

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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October 27, 2025

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OCT 27. 2025

NEWLITA E. SINDO
School Head
Cahayagan National High School
Cahayagan, Carmen, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Sindo,

We are student researchers from **Saint Michael College of Caraga**, currently conducting a study entitled **"Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide."** This research aims to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum in selected secondary schools.

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Respectfully yours,

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
Research Leader

Noted by:

KENNETH IAN BARRERA, PhD
Research Adviser

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NEWLITA E. SINDO
School Head

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP